

4.7 Case Study — Library Management System

لائبریری میں ممبر اور کتاب کا تعلق بہت-سے-بہت سے ہے، اس لیے بورو ریکارڈ نامی پل ٹیبل بناتے ہیں جس میں دونوں کی...

CS XI

Chapter 4: Data and Analysis

Lecture 09 of 15

4.7 Case Study — Library Management System

LEARN IT

A college library needs a database. Walk the seven steps examiners expect.

Step 1 — Requirements. A book has ID, title, author, publisher. A member (student/teacher) has ID, name, contact. A member can borrow many books; a book can be borrowed by different members over time. Record Issue Date and Return Date.

Step 2 — Entities. Book, Member. (Borrowing will need a third entity in step 6.)

Step 3 — Attributes. Book: BookID (PK), Title, Author, Publisher. Member: MemberID (PK), Name, ContactInfo.

Step 4 — Relationship. Member *borrow*s Book.

Step 5 — Cardinality. One member borrows many books over time; one book is borrowed by many members over time → **M:N**.

Step 6 — Resolve M:N. Add junction entity **BorrowRecord**: BorrowID (PK), MemberID (FK), BookID (FK), IssueDate, ReturnDate. Now Member 1—M BorrowRecord M—1 Book (two 1:M links).

Step 7 — Final schema.

```
Member      (MemberID PK, Name, ContactInfo)
Book        (BookID PK, Title, Author, Publisher)
BorrowRecord (BorrowID PK, MemberID FK, BookID FK, IssueDate, ReturnDate)
```



Final library ER: two 1:M relationships through the BorrowRecord junction table.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Sample rows after Sara borrows “Khushwant” on 5 Oct 2026:

BorrowID	MemberID	BookID	IssueDate	ReturnDate
5001	102	B-17	2026-10-05	

The same book can later be borrowed by Ali as BorrowID 5002 — no duplicated book title, no duplicated member address.

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CHECK YOURSELF

1. Why is BorrowRecord needed?
2. Where do IssueDate and ReturnDate belong, and why not on Book?

Answers: 1. To break M:N into two 1:M links. 2. On BorrowRecord — they belong to a *transaction*, not to the book itself (a book is issued many times).

Next lecture: 4.8 Database Objects (Tables, Forms, Queries, Reports)